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How AI shook the world in 2025 and what comes next

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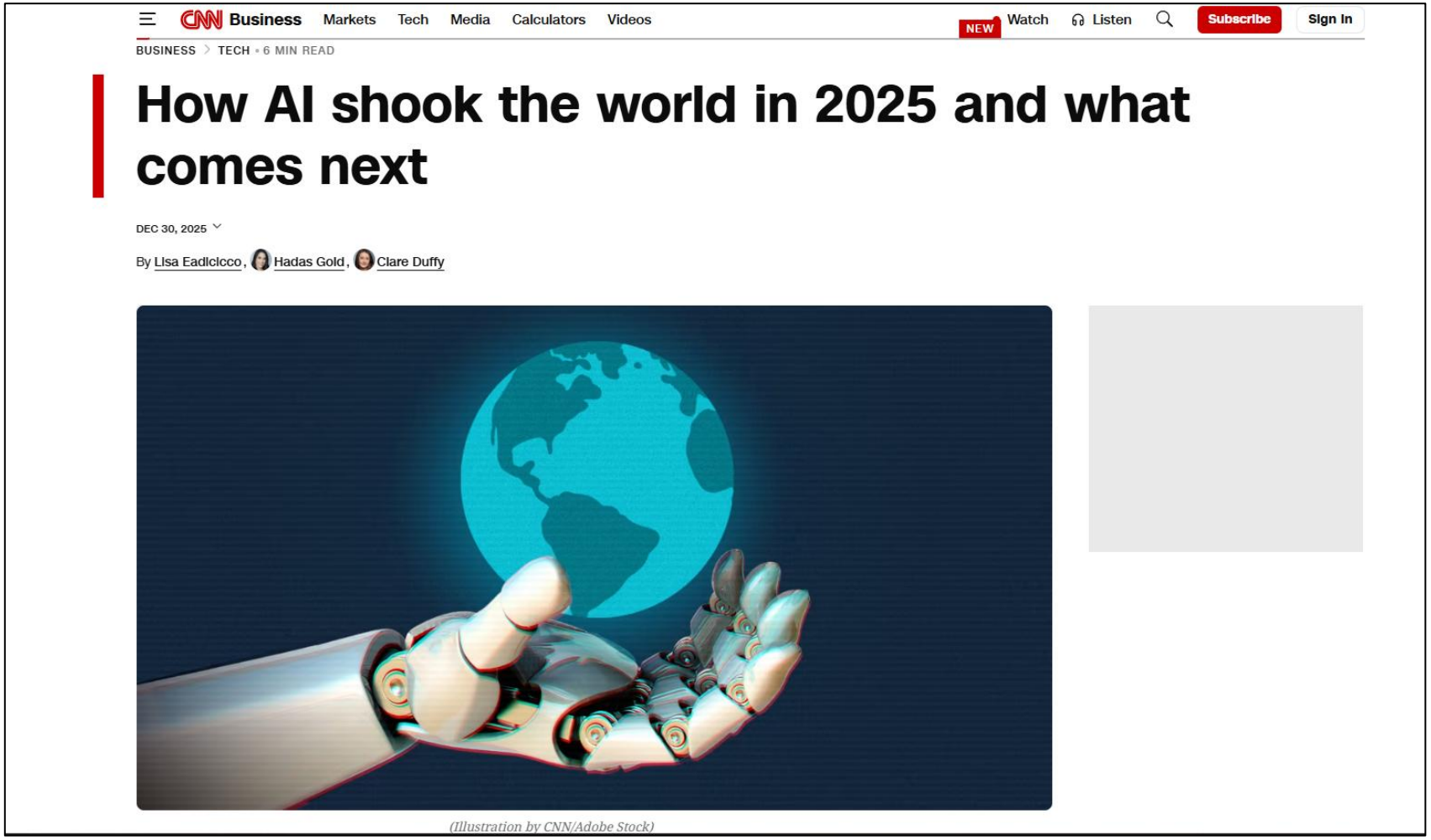

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How AI shook the world in 2025 and what comes next

DEC 30, 2025

By Lisa Eadicicco, Hadas Gold, Clare Duffy

(Illustration by CNN/Adobe Stock)

Main Findings and Arguments

The CNN article describes how artificial intelligence dramatically reshaped society in 2025, transitioning from a background technology into a dominant force influencing daily life, the economy, and government policy. The rise of generative AI tools such as ChatGPT and similar systems changed how people search for information, communicate, and complete work tasks. AI adoption expanded rapidly across industries, while governments increasingly treated AI as a strategic national asset, particularly in relation to global trade, semiconductor supply chains, and technological competition. At the same time, massive investments by major technology companies into AI infrastructure and data centers raised concerns about market concentration, economic volatility, and the possibility of an AI-driven investment bubble.

Broader Implications for Society

The article highlights significant societal concerns related to AI's rapid growth, especially in areas of mental health, regulation, and employment. Reports and legal cases raised alarms about AI chatbots contributing to emotional distress, social isolation, and harmful interactions, particularly among younger users. Experts emphasized that regulatory frameworks have not kept pace with AI development, creating gaps in accountability, safety, and privacy protections. While AI has displaced some jobs, particularly in the tech sector, it has also altered workforce skill demands and created new opportunities, leading to uneven economic impacts. Overall, the article suggests that AI will continue to accelerate social change, requiring governments, institutions, and individuals to adapt to ongoing technological disruption.

Relevance or Potential Influence on the Construction Industry

The developments discussed in the article are highly relevant to the construction industry. Large-scale investments in AI infrastructure, including data centers, power systems, and advanced facilities, are increasing demand for construction projects and specialized construction expertise. AI-driven tools have the potential to transform construction planning, scheduling, cost estimation, and project management, improving productivity while increasing the need for digitally skilled workers. At the same time, regulatory uncertainty and workforce disruption highlighted in the article suggest that construction firms must carefully manage AI adoption by balancing efficiency gains with workforce training, safety considerations, and ethical use of AI technologies across construction operations.

Thank You